Checking for Understanding

Questions that push the presenter's thinking deeper.

The inquiry path for each presenter

1 · Identify the point of confusion	"What is your question?"
2 · What do they already know?	"What can you tell me about it?"
3 · Clarify understanding	"What does ___ mean?"
4 · Push the thinking	"What have you already tried?" "Is there another way to look at it?" "Where could you find more information?"
5 · Decide where they are	Clearly understands → "What would happen if you changed ___?" · Needs more inquiry → "What have we overlooked?" · Still confused → "What questions do you still have?"
6 · Check for understanding	"How would you teach this to a friend?"
7 · Reflect	"What did you learn?"

Critical thinking standards

Clarity	Can you say more? Can you give an example? Can you draw a picture of what you mean?
Accuracy	How could we check that? How could we find out if that is true?
Precision	Can you be more specific? Can you give more details?
Relevance	How does that connect to the question? How does that help us with this problem?
Depth	What makes this a hard problem? What parts are tricky?
Breadth	Is there another way to look at this? Another point of view?
Logic	Does this all fit together? Does your answer follow from the evidence?
Significance	What is the most important part to focus on?

Socratic follow-ups

Clarify

- What do you mean by ___?
- Could you put that another way?
- Could you give an example?
- Can someone summarize what ___ just said?

Probe reasons and evidence

- How do you know?
- What makes you think that?
- What evidence supports that?
- How could we find out if that's true?

Probe assumptions

- What are you assuming here?
- Is that always true?
- What could we assume instead?

Other viewpoints

- Is there another way to see this?
- What would someone who disagrees say?
- What's an alternative?

Implications

- If that's true, what else must be true?
- What would happen as a result?
- What effect would that have?

Question the question

- Is the question clear to everyone?
- Can we break the question into smaller questions?
- What do we need to know first?